
PURPOSE: To establish policies and procedures for the proper use of License Plate Recognition (LPR) systems by the Jacksonville Police Department, including Motorola LPRs and AVA Quad Cameras with LPR detection.

POLICY: It is the policy of this Department that all members abide by the guidelines set forth herein when using LPR systems. These systems enhance productivity, effectiveness, and officer safety.

DEFINITIONS:

- I. FOUO: For Official Use Only
- II. LPR License Plate Recognition/License Plate Reader
- III. OCR: Optical Character Recognition
- IV. Read: Digital images of license plates and vehicles and associated metadata captured by the LPR system.
- V. Alert: A visual and/or auditory notice triggered when the LPR system receives a potential “hit” on a license plate.
- VI. Hit: A read matched to a plate previously registered on an agency’s “hot list.”
- VII. Hot list: License plate number of stolen cars, vehicles owned by persons of interest, and vehicles associated with AMBER Alerts regularly added to “hot lists.”
- VIII. Fixed LPR system: LPR cameras permanently affixed to a structure.
- IX. Mobile LPR system: LPR cameras affixed to a law enforcement vehicle.
- X. Portable LPR system: Transportable LPR cameras deployable in various venues

PROCEDURES:

- I. GENERAL USAGE:
 - A. The use of LPR systems is restricted to public safety-related missions.
 - B. LPR systems and associated equipment are authorized for official public safety purposes. Misuse may result in disciplinary actions.
 - C. LPR systems and data are the property of the Jacksonville Police Department and intended for conducting official business.
- II. ADMINISTRATION:

- A. The agency shall designate an employee(s) with administrative oversight for LPR system deployment and operations who is responsible for:
 - a. Establishing protocols for access, collection, storage, and retention of LPR data and associated media files.
 - b. Establishing protocols to preserve and document LPR reads and “alerts” or “hits” that are acted on in the field or associated with investigations or prosecutions.
 - c. Establishing protocols to establish and ensure the security and integrity of data captured, stored, and/or retained by the LPR system.
 - d. Ensuring the proper selection of the personnel approved to operate the LPR system and maintaining an adequate number of trainees:
 - e. Maintaining records identifying approved LPR deployments and documenting their results, including appropriate documentation of significant incidents and arrests that are related to LPR usage.
 - f. Authorizing any request for LPR systems use or data access according to the policies and guidelines of the Jacksonville Police Department.
- B. Designated, trained personnel shall check equipment on a regular basis to ensure functionality and camera alignment. Any equipment that falls outside expected functionality shall be removed from service until deficiencies have been corrected.
- C. LPR systems repairs, hardware or software, shall be made by agency authorized sources.

III. LICENSE PLATE READER SYSTEM USAGE

- A. LPR operation and access to LPR collected data shall be for official agency purposes only.
- B. Only officers who have been properly trained in the use and operational protocols of the LPR system shall be permitted to use it.
- C. LPR Alerts/Hits: Prior to initiation of the stop:
 - a. Visually verify that the vehicle plate number matches the plate number run by the LPR system, including both alphanumeric characters of the license plate and the state of issuance.
 - b. Verify the current status of the plate through dispatch or MDT query when circumstances allow.
- D. In each case in which an alert or a hit is triggered, the user should record the disposition of the alert and the hit into the LPR system.
- E. Hot lists may be updated manually if the user enters a specific plate into the LPR system and wants to be alerted when that plate is located. Whenever a plate is manually entered into the LPR system, the officer should document the reason.
- F. Special Details: LPR use during nontraditional deployments (e.g., special operations or during a criminal investigation) must be approved by the administrator.
- G. Searches of historical data within the LPR system should be done in accordance with established departmental policies and procedures, ACIC regulations and state law.

IV. LPR DATA SHARING AND DISSEMINATION

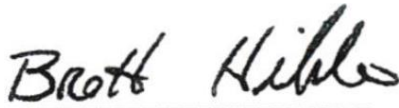
- A. LPR data should be considered FOUO and can be shared for legitimate law enforcement purposes:
 - a. When LPR data are disseminated outside the agency, it should be documented in a secondary dissemination log.
 - b. Information sharing among agencies should be dictated in accordance with the Jacksonville Police Department Policy.

V. RETENTION

- A. All LPR system data will be stored on the designated LPR system server for a period not to exceed 150 days to comply with § 12-12-1803(b).
- B. Captured plate data obtained by the Jacksonville Police department may be retained as part of an ongoing investigation and shall be destroyed at the conclusion of either:
 - i. An investigation that does not result in any criminal charges being filed; or
 - ii. Any criminal action undertaken in the matter involving the captured plate data.
- C. No data captured will be sold, traded or exchanged for any purpose.
- D. Captured plate data obtained by the Jacksonville Police Department under § 12-12-1803(b)(1) that indicates evidence of an offense may be shared with other law enforcement agencies.

VI. TRAINING

- A. The Jacksonville Police Department will provide training for the use of LPR systems to any new employees and a signature of receipt of this policy will be mandatory.



Brett C. Hibbs
Chief of Police